

EXPANSION · OPTIONAL · ANNEX II

EDITION VIII · DLC

★ ★ ★ WAR DEPARTMENT EXPANSION FILE ★ ★ ★



– The Cruellest Years – Expansion Rules

Optional Content Beyond the Base Game

Asian Theatre · Occupied Nations · Advanced Combat

TWO CHINAS · LIBERATION WARS · RISK & INFLATION

Expansion Annex · Edition VIII · Add these rules when the table agrees

WHAT'S IN THIS DOCUMENT

The base game emphasizes Europe. Everything else lives here.

The base game of *The Cruellest Years* is European — designed to play in about an hour with rules a new player can absorb in 10 minutes. The Second World War was not only European. The Asian theatre, the occupied nations, and several advanced combat options each add real complexity. We have moved them here so the base game stays approachable, and so the table can choose how deep it wants to go.

Each section is a self-contained expansion. Use any combination at the start of a game by agreement of all players. Once chosen, these rules override the base game.

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Base rules in the Rulebook. Numbers in Stats & Cards.

OVER-RANGE STRIKE

Push your guns just a little farther than they were built for.

In the base game, your unit's Range is final — you attack within Range or not at all. The Over-Range Strike rule lets you push beyond at the cost of a coin flip.

The Rule

During the Move & Attack phase, a unit may attempt to attack a target one unit of distance beyond its printed Range. Declare the over-range attack, then flip a coin:



Heads - Hit

The strike hits normally. Apply your Attack value as damage. The unit's action is spent — it cannot move after attacking.



Tails - Miss

No damage is dealt. The unit's action is still spent — over-range attempts always cost the attempt, not just the hit.

Limit: Over-range strikes extend Range by one tile only. Cannot chain or combine with any other range-extending ability.

Why This Lives in the DLC

The over-range strike adds a layer of risk-management to every attack. It rewards experienced players who understand probability and over-extension. It also slows combat — every borderline attack needs a coin flip. The base game omits it so first-time players can resolve combat without extra randomness layered on top.

INFLATION – PRINT THE MONEY NOW, PAY LATER

Trade tomorrow's economy for today's army.

Every government in the Second World War borrowed from its future to fight its present. Germany printed Reichsmarks. Britain liquidated its empire. The United States ran the largest deficit in its history. The Inflation rule gives every nation that same option – and the same long-term cost.

The Ability

PRINT THE MONEY

During your *Use Abilities* phase, add +10 gold to your treasury immediately. Activate once per turn (no cooldown). Each activation places one Inflation Marker on your nation card.

The Cost

Inflation Markers do not go away. From the turn after activation, every Collect phase:

 Per Marker Per Turn Lose 1 gold per marker. No gold? Lose 1 weapon. No weapons? Lose 1 population.	 No Cure Inflation Markers cannot be removed for the rest of the game.
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The Math & When to Use It

One Inflation Marker pays for itself after 10 turns of loss. The strategy works if you can win before the markers eat you – past that horizon you're paying a permanent tax. Best cases:

- Surprise offensive – 5 turns from victory and need one more wave of units.
- Last-ditch defense – You need a Tank now, not next turn.
- Emergency rescue – An ally is collapsing. Fund relief at the cost of your post-war economy.

The temptation to print "just one more" has destroyed real economies. Don't let it destroy yours.

THE TWO CHINAS

A Nationalist government and a Communist resistance, fighting Japan — and each other.

In the 1930s, the Republic of China was not a single state. Chiang Kai-shek and Mao Zedong shared a fragile truce against the Japanese invasion — and turned their guns on each other when they could. The base game collapses both into one Chinese player. This expansion restores the original split.

Three Modes of Play



Unified China - One player

BASE GAME DEFAULT

One player commands all of China. Both leader cards (Mao and Chiang) are available — the player chooses one.



United Front - Two players

COOPERATIVE

Two players share China cooperatively. Treasury and unit pool are shared. Each plays one leader. Disagreements resolved by die roll.



Civil Truce - Two players

INDEPENDENT POWERS

The dossier splits between KMT and CCP. They act as independent powers — may cooperate, betray, or stay in armed truce while jointly facing Japan.

CIVIL TRUCE - THE 60 / 40 SPLIT

KMT player chooses Chiang Kai-shek; CCP player chooses Mao Zedong. Both use Guerrilla Infantry trait.

Table · Two Chinas (Civil Truce) WD FORM 3-C

Statistic	KMT (Nationalist)	CCP (Communist)	China (combined)
Cities	4	1	5
Factories	1	0	1
Population	4	2	6
Treasury	2	1	3
Init. Weapons	1	0	1
Init. Units	3	2	5

Both players may declare team victory together, or turn on each other. Capturing the other China's city or factory: it produces for the captor. Both players are at war with Japan from turn 1 unless they negotiate a separate peace.

OCCUPIED NATIONS

Korea, British India, and the Pacific dominions begin under another power. Here is how they break free.

Korea begins fully occupied by Japan. Korean territory produces for Japan. The Korean player may only build resistance using Kim Gu's *Resistance Network* ability. To play independently: drive Japanese units out of Korean home territory and hold it for one full round. Once liberated, Korea plays normally.

British India and Pacific dominions begin subordinate to the UK. The subordinate nation must follow the UK player's orders on major actions and cannot declare war on a target refused by the UK. To play independently: declare independence and survive one full round without losing the capital to British forces. Once held, the nation may even turn against its former master.

Best for advanced or cooperative play. A new player is better served by one of the eight Great Powers.

WAR DEPARTMENT EXPANSION FILE

The Cruellest Years

DLC - Expansion Rules

Optional Content Beyond the Base Game



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COMPANION VOLUMES

Quick Rulebook · Edition VIII

Stats & Cards — Data Annex · Edition VIII

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